

Digital divide

Not everybody has access to digital devices and the internet, and the difference between those who do and those who do not is called the digital divide.

Getting online

A great way to measure the digital divide is to look at access to the internet. To use the internet, a person needs some form of digital device, they must understand how to use it, and to be in a place where internet access is possible and not extremely expensive. Generally speaking, people in the developed world have greater access to the internet than those in the developing world. Even within countries, there is a digital divide between rich and poor citizens.

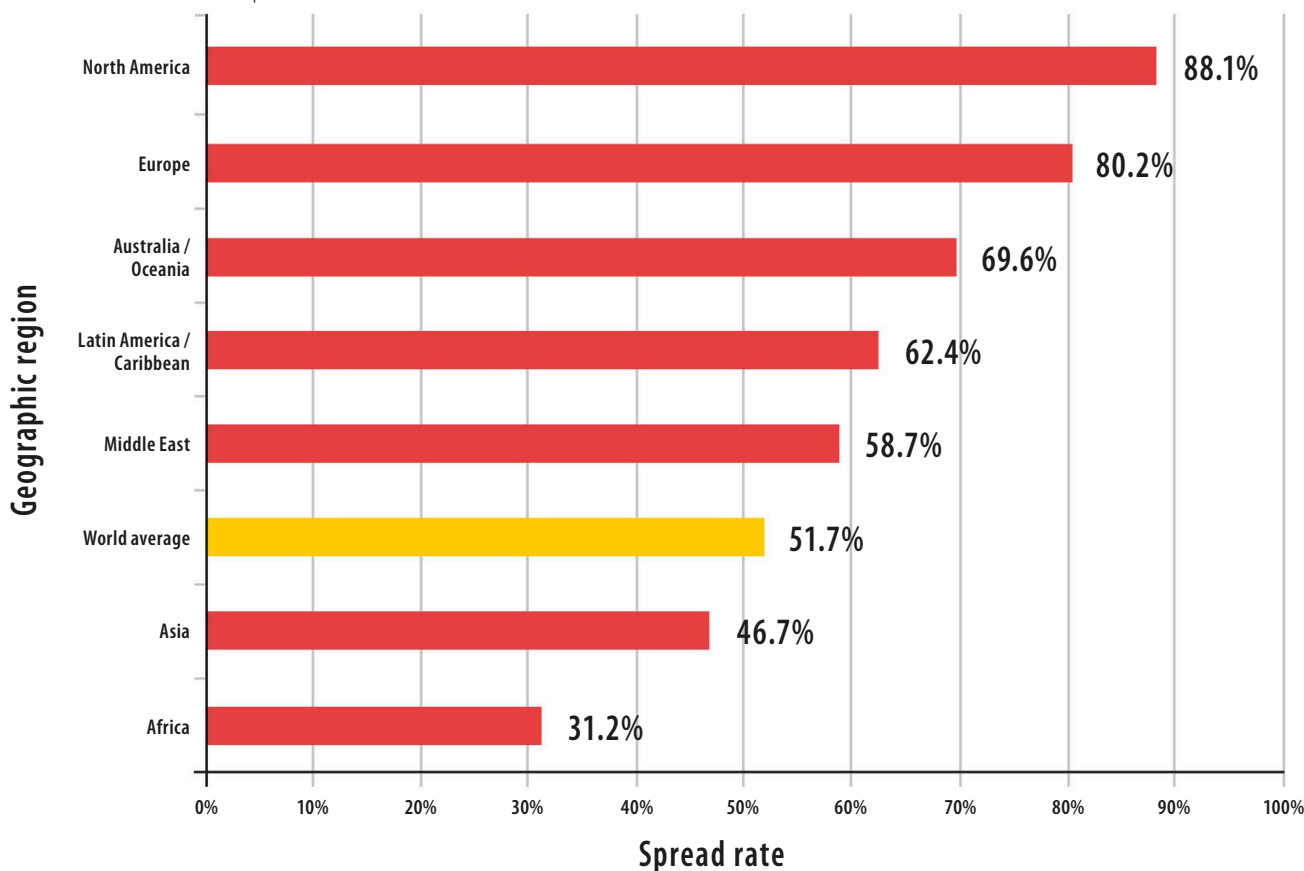
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The **digital divide** is the difference between people **who have access** to digital devices and the internet and those **who do not**.



△ Internet world spread rates by geographic regions

Access to the internet is not equally possible everywhere. Whereas North America, Europe, and Australia enjoy relatively high rates of online access, South America, most of Asia, and Africa do not. These figures vary from country to country: about 94 per cent of people in Japan are online, but the average for Asia is less than half of that.

Source: Internet World Stats:
www.internetworldstats.com/stats.htm
 Correct as of 30 June 2017.